Application Help

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SAP Business Network Freight Collaboration | LBN

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SAP Business Network Freight Collaboration

SAP Business Network Freight Collaboration improves supply chain efficiency by connecting business partners on a collaborative network that supports jointly managing transactions, exchanging documents, and sharing insights across the value chain. For instance, upon invitation from a shipper, a carrier can onboard onto the network and collaborate with shippers on freight tendering, invoicing and milestone reporting.

SAP Business Network Freight Collaboration runs on SAP Business Technology Platform (SAP BTP), utilizing one of the following infrastructures:

- Amazon Web Services (AWS) infrastructure, hosted in a data center in Frankfurt, Germany
- Microsoft Azure infrastructure, hosted in a data center in Washington state, US
- Google Cloud infrastructure, hosted in a data center in Dammam, Saudi Arabia

The data used in the solution is also stored in the respective data center.

Information for shippers:

Collaborative managed transactions supported in SAP Business Network Freight Collaboration are tailored to the relevant SAP backend systems. For freight collaboration scenarios, SAP Business Network Freight Collaboration offers out-of-the-box connectivity to shippers with the following systems:

- SAP Transportation Management (on-premise) or Transportation Management embedded in SAP S/4HANA (on-premise)
- SAP S/4HANA Cloud Private Edition
- SAP Logistics Management

> **Note**
> The following documentation uses the term *SAP S/4HANA* to refer to both SAP S/4HANA Cloud Private Edition and SAP S/4HANA (on-premise). If any of the information provided applies to only SAP S/4HANA Cloud Private Edition or SAP S/4HANA, this will be clearly specified.

For more information about supported releases, see SAP Note 2620322. In addition, out-of-the box connectivity is delivered for truck carrier networks, including project44 for visibility services and B2B carrier connectivity for freight tendering and subcontracting. Selected digital freight forwarders support on-demand road transportation with real-time pricing and subcontracting.

To learn more about the SAP Business Network add-ons for project44 visibility services, see the Feature Scope Description for project44 Add-Ons and the Configuration and Application Guide for project44 Add-Ons.

Data Protection and Privacy

You use the **Data Protection and Privacy** apps to manage personal and sensitive personal data of employees, individual customers, and contacts.

Data processing systems store master data or transactional data used to perform business processes and to document them. In many cases, it involves the personal data of employees, individual customers, and contacts. In many countries, the storage, disclosure, and removal of such personal data from data storage systems must be in accordance with statutory data protection

laws. One requirement in many countries is that the personal data can only be stored if a clear business reason for this data retention exists. Most data protection legislation proscribes fixed retention periods, defining how long data can be stored in data systems, after which it must be deleted. In addition, legislation in many countries stipulates that the data protection officer must disclose the personal data of individuals, when requested for it.

Retention Management

SAP Business Network Freight Collaboration restricts the access of personal data on completion of its business purpose. That is, not all the user groups can access the personal data after the expiration of originally defined residence period.

The **Retention Management** app enables you to define rules for residence and blocking of personal data for apps that belong to a specific application group. These rules restrict the usage of documents containing personal data.

In the **Retention Management** app, you define the residence period and the blocking period. The residence period and blocking period are together called as the retention period.

ℹ Note

You must familiarize yourself with the following important definitions relevant for using the Retention Management app:

Residence Period

The period between the end of business and the end of purpose for a data set during which the data remains in the database and can be used in case of subsequent processes related to the original purpose. At the end of the residence period, the data is blocked.

Blocking Period

The period between the residence period and the deletion of the data is the blocking period. In the blocking period, only users with special privileges, such as a data protection officer, can access the data. At the end of the configured blocking period, the data is deleted.

Retention Period

The period between the end of the last business activity involving a specific object and the deletion of the corresponding data, subject to applicable laws. For example, in the **Freight Requests for Quotation** app, business partner is a master data and the end of purpose of this master data is until the business partner is in the network.

The retention period is a combination of the residence period and the blocking period.

Data Subject

An identified or identifiable natural person. An identifiable natural person is one who can be identified, directly or indirectly, by reference to an identifier such as a name, an identification number, location data, an online identifier or to one or more factors specific to the physical, physiological, genetic, mental, economic, cultural, or social identity of that natural person.

Defining Residence and Blocking Periods

To define the residence period and blocking period of various applications, perform the following:

1. Sign in to the Fiori Launchpad and choose the **Retention Management** tile.
2. Select an application type.

3. Enter a residence period.

   The residence period is the period between the end of business and the end of purpose for a data set during which the data remains in the database and can be used in case of subsequent processes related to the original purpose. At the end of the residence period, the data is blocked.

   Note that if you do not specify a residence period, the system by default assigns a residence period of 12 months for the application type.

4. Enter a blocking period.

   The blocking period is the period between the residence period and the deletion of the data is the blocking period. In the blocking period, only users with special privileges, such as a Data Protection Officer (DPO), can access the data. At the end of the configured blocking period, the data is deleted.

   Note that if you do not specify a blocking period, the system by default assigns a blocking period of 12 months for the application type.

5. Choose Save.

   The system stores the residence and blocking periods for the specific application type.

i Note

For the **Define User Settings** application type, the system displays only the **Data Subject ID** field. You must enter the identifier of the person in which the system stores the personal settings. When you choose **Delete**, the system deletes the personal settings of the individual from the system.

Blocking Store

Once the residence period ends, the data moves to the blocking period. In the blocking period, only users with special privileges, such as a data protection officer, can access the data. At the end of the configured blocking period, the system deletes the data.

The data protection officer can log into the Fiori Launchpad and choose the **Blocking Store** app to access all the documents that are in the blocking period. To view a document, the user can download the document in a text file format by choosing the **Download** button.

- Identifier

  Displays the unique identifier for the document.

- Status

  Displays the status of the document, for example, in blocking period.

- End of business

  Displays the date when the document got into the end of business state.

- App name

  Displays the name of the app with which the data is associated.

- Administration information

Personal Data Record

Data subjects have the right to receive information regarding their personal data undergoing processing. The personal data record feature helps you to comply with the relevant legal requirements for data protection by allowing you to search for and retrieve all personal data for a specified data subject. The search results are displayed in a comprehensive and structured list containing all personal data of the data subject specified, organized according to the purpose for which the data was collected and processed.

SAP Business Network Freight Collaboration uses Personal Data Manager for information and retrieval of personal data. A user with the right role can access the Fiori Launchpad of Personal Data Manager and search for the transactions that have the data of the data subject. To access the Fiord Launchpad of Personal Data Manager, use an URL of the following format:

https://<your-subdomain>- pdm-portal.<domain-name>/sites

For more information about Personal Data Manager, see the Administration Guide for Shippers.

Audit Log

Personal data is subject to frequent changes. Therefore, for review purposes or as a result of legal regulations, it may be necessary to track the changes made to this data. When these changes are logged, you should be able to check which employee made which change, the date and time, the previous value, and the current value, depending on the configuration. It is also possible to analyze errors in this way.

SAP Business Network Freight Collaboration supports change and audit log. When you change any personal information, the system updates the audit log. Users with the required authorization can request for the change log.

To request for a log, the authorized user must create an SAP support message in the component `BC-NEO-AUDITLOG`. For more information about how to request for audit logs, see Audit Log Viewer for the Cloud Foundry Environment.

Manage Business Profile

Whether you are a shipper, solution owner, or logistics provider, you will land on the company profile page in SAP Business Network when opening the **Manage Business Profile** app. On this page, you can manage and adjust your company information as per your needs. This enables potential partners and relevant stakeholders to know more about your company's service coverage, capabilities, and strength.

You can maintain the basic information about your company. This includes but is not limited to the type of organization, year founded, and annual revenue to help shippers and solution owners evaluate you as a potential logistics provider.

The Product and Service Categories, Ship-to or Service Locations, and Industries sections of your company profile allow you to provide detailed information about the products or services you offer, the locations you ship to or provide services, and the industries you serve. This information is critical because shippers and solution owners usually discover your company based on the product and service categories and ship-to or service locations.

The Additional Addresses section provides you with an effective and intuitive way to add and manage addresses beyond the primary business address, such as branch offices, regional offices, warehouses, or other physical sites associated with your company. Including these addresses provides a comprehensive overview of your company's geographical reach and operational scope.

The Contacts section enables you to create multiple individual contacts and assign them one or multiple roles, such as Sales Representative, Marketing Manager, and Technical Contact, designating them as companywide contacts. This guarantees that their contact details are readily available to all current and potential trading partners on the network.

More Information

Company information was once maintained via the **Manage Business Profile** app. Although the **Company Profile** page in SAP Business Network uses a similar user interface to the app, a few differences can be noticed. For detailed information, see the following table.

User Interface Comparison

Manage Business Profile	Company Profile
Subdomain	N/A
Logo	Company Logo
LBN ID	N/A You can view the LBN ID by choosing **Manage Alternate IDs** in the System Connections app.
Company Role	N/A
Account Type	N/A
Connection Status	Relationship status
Address	Address and Additional Addresses See Creating Additional Addresses.
Contact Details	Contacts See Managing Contact Information.
Year of Inception	Year Founded
Gross Revenue in USD	Revenue
Employee strength	Number of Employees
Industry Group	N/A
Industry	Industries Served
Geographical Coverage	Ship-to and Service Location
Make my business profile visible to potential business partners	Moved to Profile Settings.
Automatically accept connection requests	Moved to the Manage Invitations app See Settings on Invitations.
Alternate Identifier	Moved to the System Conections app
Created By	N/A
Created On	N/A
Changed By	N/A
Changed On	Last Updated

Edit Company Profile

Use this procedure to edit your **Company Profile** information and ensure that it's complete and accurate to attract the most business partners.

1. On the **Company Profile** page, click a pencil icon to edit the information in a section, and enter or revise values as necessary. Note the following constraints and guidelines when you edit your company profile:
    - **Company D-U-N-S Number**—A nine-digit number issued by Dun & Bradstreet, Inc. to identify each corporate location of an organization. You can obtain a D-U-N-S number or look up your company's existing number on Dun & Bradstreet's website, https://www.dnb.com .
    - **Supplier Legal Form**—Choose the type of business entity or legal status of your company from the dropdown. The list of values varies per country/region.
    - **Year Founded**—Enter the year in yyyy format.
    - **Number of Employees**—The approximate number of people who work for your organization.
    - **Annual Revenue**—Select a currency range. If you prefer not to state your annual revenue, scroll to the bottom of the list and select **Contact Company for Information**.
    - **Business Type**—Check the business types that apply to your company.
    - **Product and Service Categories**—Select your company's products and services by clicking **Add Category**.
    - **Ship-to or Service Location**—Select the locations your company ships to or serves by clicking **Add Locations**.
    - **Industries Served**—Select the industries your company serves.
2. Click **Save** when you finish editing a section.
3. To add additional addresses to your company profile, select **Additional Addresses** from the left navigation pane. For detailed information, see Creating Additional Addresses.
4. To add contact information to your company profile, select **Contacts** from the left navigation pane. For detailed information, see Managing Contact Information.

Creating Additional Addresses

To add an additional address to your company profile, follow these steps:

1. Select **Additional Addresses** from the left navigation pane of the **Company Profile** page.
2. On the **Additional Addresses** page, click **Create**.
3. On the **Create Address** page, specify the following fields:
    - **Address Name** (Mandatory): Give a unique name to easily identify this address.
    - **Address Type**: Specify the type of address.
    - **Country/Region** (Mandatory): Specify the country or region where the address is located.
    - **Address Line 1** (Mandatory): Enter the primary address information.
    - **Address Line 2** (Optional): Include additional address details, if applicable.
    - **Address Line 3** (Optional): Include further address details, if necessary.
    - **City** (Mandatory): Specify the city where the address is located.
    - **State** (Mandatory): Provide the state or region where the address is situated.

- **Zip** (Mandatory): Enter the postal or ZIP code for the address.
- **Contact**: You can add contact details associated with this address, including:
  - **Phone Number**: This field is mandatory.
  - **Mobile Number**: Optionally provide a mobile contact number.
  - **Fax Number**: If applicable, provide a fax number.
  - **Email**: This field is mandatory for email communication regarding this address.

4. Once all required information is entered, click **Save**.

   The new address will appear in the **Addresses** table.

5. Repeat the process to add more addresses.

Managing Contact Information

Companywide Contact

Companywide contacts have their contact information accessible to both current and potential business partners on the network.

Assign individuals in your company as companywide contacts. This ensures that your business partners know the right people to contact for various issues or questions. To do this, follow these steps:

1. Select **Contacts** from the left navigation pane of the **Company Profile** page.
2. Click **Create** in the upper right corner of the **Contact Personnel with Companywide Assignments** table.
3. On the **Create Contact Personnel Entry** page, specify the basic information and address of the contact.

   The basic information includes **Contact Name**, **Email**, **Business Title**, **Phone**, **Fax**, and **Company Assignment**. Each contact must have a name, phone number, and email.

   The **Company Assignment** field specifies the companywide roles assigned to a contact. If this field is specified, the contact is designated as a companywide contact for the selected role, and their contact information is accessible to all business partners on the network. Each contact personnel can be assigned with multiple companywide roles.

4. After providing the necessary information, click **Create**.
5. To edit a contact, click **Edit** in the upper right corner of the table.
6. To delete a contact, Click **Delete** in the upper right corner of the table.

   After a contact is deleted, all its assignments will be removed as well.

Profile Settings

You can specify the visibility and availability of your company profile on the **Profile Settings** page. If you are a shipper or solution owner, before trying to connect with business partners that operate in a different data center, you must first make your company profile available across all data centers of SAP Business Network for Logistics.

Steps to Configure Profile Settings

1. Open your company profile.

2. Click the **Options** menu in the upper-right corner of your profile and select **Profile settings**.

3. On the **Profile Settings** page, locate the section labeled **Search Results Visibility**:

    a. Toggle **Show my profile in search results** to allow your profile to appear in search results.

    This setting determines whether your company profile is visible to potential business partners in their search results. Once your company profile becomes visible, shippers or solution owners can discover your company on the network and send you connection requests for further partnership.

    Default value: Yes

    b. Toggle **Replicate to global regions of SAP Business Network** to allow profile data replication across data centers.

    This setting determines whether your profile data will be replicated to other data centers in SAP Business Network for Logistics. For carriers and data providers, this setting is enabled by default. Shippers and solution owners need to enable it manually.

    > **Note**
    > Once enabled, this setting cannot be reversed.

4. Click **Save** to confirm your settings.

Results

- Once **Show my profile in search results** is enabled, your profile will become searchable and visible to potential business partners. Otherwise, your company profile will not be shown in any search results, and thus, no business partners can reach you for further connections.
- Once **Replicate to global regions of SAP Business Network** is enabled, your company profile data will be replicated across all data centers of SAP Business Network for Logistics. Future updates to your profile will also be automatically synchronized across all data centers. For shippers and solution owners, enabling this setting allows for establishing cross-data-center connections. If this setting is not enabled, your company profile will be only available in the data center where you initially onboarded. As a result, no cross-data-center connections can be established.

Carrier Apps and APIs

With SAP Business Network Freight Collaboration, you as a carrier can use the the apps to get started on the network and to perform your daily tasks in the areas of freight tendering, subcontracting, dock appointment scheduling, milestone reporting and freight settlement.

> **Note**
> These apps are also suitable for logistics service providers that perform the role of a carrier who receives freight requests for quotation or freight orders from an ordering party.

The SAP Business Network Logistics Provider, basic membership page is the central entry point for logistics providers (carriers and data contributors) to find all relevant assets regarding activation, integration and operation of SAP Business Network for Logistics.

Carrier APIs

As a carrier, you can use the APIs in SAP Business Network Freight Collaboration to perform your daily tasks in the areas of freight contracting, freight booking, freight tracking, and freight settlement.

For more information, see https://help.sap.com/doc/e1b2026259d84fc29e6e6760da815011/LBN/en-US/15db9545fb79453c90e49ebad6cc57fc.html.

Define User Settings (Carrier)

The **Define User Settings** app allows you to define defaults that best suit the way you work. The settings that you make in the app serve as the default settings in various other apps for SAP Business Network Freight Collaboration.

Distance

In this section, you can define the default unit of measurement for distance. The system uses this setting in other apps in your area.

Notification Subscriptions

In this section, you can subscribe to notifications for various scenarios and specify the email address and preferred language for receiving the notifications. Note that you cannot subscribe to a scenario without maintaining an email address.

When you subscribe to notifications for a scenario, the system can send email notifications based on the settings you make in the **Manage Notification Settings** app.

For more information on managing notification settings, see Manage Notification Settings (Carrier).

Manage Notification Settings (Carrier)

You can use this app to schedule reminder notifications for some of the business processes for which you may need an alert.

The system sends you notifications via emails.

The **Manage Notification Settings** app consists of the following areas:

- List of scenarios

  This area displays the scenarios for which you can configure alerts.

- Filter

  You can use this filter to filter the scenarios. When you select a scenario from this drop-down menu, the system displays only that specific scenario.

- Configuration details

  The system displays the following in this area:

  - Configurations

    The system displays notification types and the settings that you can configure for each type.

    On-event notification refers to the email notification that you receive at the time when a target event happens, for example, when you receive an invitation from a shipper.

    Post-event notifications refer to the notifications you receive after the target event happens, for example, after you have received the invitation.

  - Subscribers